

What is Disaster Management?

Preparedness -- activities prior to a disaster.

Examples: preparedness plans; emergency exercises/training; warning systems.

Response -- activities during a disaster.

Examples: public warning systems; emergency operations; search and rescue.

Recovery -- activities following a disaster.

Examples: temporary housing; claims processing and grants; long-term medical care and counseling.

Mitigation - activities that reduce the effects of disasters.

Examples: building codes and zoning; vulnerability analyses; public education.



Paradigm shift in DM

- Disaster management, which earlier relied on reactive mechanism and processes, is now adopting a preventive and mitigation-based approach
- The HPC provided a new culture to the area of disaster management by indicating that
- There are four key pillars of this activity namely:
 - a) Culture of Preparedness
 - b) Culture of Quick Response
 - c) Culture of Strategic Thinking; and
 - d) Culture of Prevention

Culture of Preparedness

- The Committee expressed that though it is **not possible to completely do away** with the devastation being caused by natural hazards, the destruction arising out of it **can be minimized**.
- It can be done through warning systems, community preparedness measures and other precautionary and mitigatory measures.

Disaster Preparedness

- Disaster preparedness is an effective way of lessening the impact of disasters, which occur on a small as well as large-scale.
- It acts as an effective link between emergency response, and rehabilitation.

Disaster Preparedness

- The United Nations Disaster Relief Office defines Disaster Preparedness as
- A series of measures designed to organize and facilitate timely and effective rescue, relief and rehabilitation operations in cases of disaster.
- Measures of preparedness include among others,
 - Setting up disaster relief machinery,
 - Formulation of emergency relief plans,
 - Training of specific groups (and vulnerable communities) to undertake rescue and relief,
 - Stock piling supplies and earmarking funds for relief operations".

Disaster Preparedness

- The concept of disaster preparedness is presently gaining increasing recognition, as it is being realized that **investing in disaster preparedness can save lives and property and reduce relief assistance costs**. Hence, preventing and preparing for disasters is important.
- The World Health Organization in its Report of the Regional Meeting on Health aspects of Disaster Preparedness indicated **that India is among the five countries in the South Asian** region that meet many of the criteria for disaster preparedness and has a legal framework in place.
- The Disaster Management Act 2005 enacted by Parliament provides a framework for the effective management of disaster and for matters connected with it.

Disaster Preparedness

- Preparedness involves different set of activities before, during and after the disaster:

Preparedness Activities before the onset of Disaster

- Formulation of **disaster preparedness plans** at national, state, local and community levels.
- **Generation and disseminating information** through mass media about the potential hazards, their frequency of occurrence and associated risks.
- Installation of appropriate **forecasting** and **warning systems**.
- Strengthening of physical infrastructure.
- Evacuation of people to safer areas.

Preparedness Activities during the Event

- Provision of food, shelter, medical and first aid services.
- Security arrangements to prevent occurrence of untoward incidents.

Post-disaster Preparedness Activities

- Rescue operations for affected.
- Proper relief distribution including food, clothes and medicines.
- Restoration of communication system.
- Damage assessment and immediate financial assistance.

- There is presently a paradigm shift towards **strengthening preparedness at various levels**,
- This includes the government organizations at all levels, educational institutions, non-governmental organizations, community-based organizations, media and community.

The preparedness strategy aims at:

- Developing, strengthening and making accessible to people, early warning systems and making them alert and responsive to emergencies;
- Reducing the vulnerability of households and communities in disaster-prone areas and improving their ability to cope with disaster effects;
- Strengthening institutional mechanisms and capacities of the government at various levels, NGOs, communities and other institutions in disaster preparedness and post- disaster response; and
- Establishing networks and linkages between public and private organizations, NGOs, community-based organizations, community and other key stakeholders to foster improved coordination of preparedness efforts.

Sendai Framework for Disaster Risk Reduction

<https://vikaspedia.in/social-welfare/disaster-management-1/sendai-framework-for-disaster-risk-reduction>

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<https://vikaspedia.in/social-welfare/disaster-management-1/sendai-framework-for-disaster-risk-reduction>

Indian Framework for Disaster Risk Reduction

Highlights of National disaster management plan

<https://vikaspedia.in/social-welfare/disaster-management-1/national-disaster-management-plan>

National disaster management plan

<https://reliefweb.int/sites/reliefweb.int/files/resources/ndmp-2019.pdf>